

**Orthodox Church of the
Resurrection of Christ
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**Great Lent begins
Monday, Feb. 23**

**Sunday, 22 February 2026
Divine Liturgy Sundays at 9:30 AM
Confessions before Liturgy**

**Cheese-fare Sunday
Sunday of Forgiveness (*today*)
Прощенное Воскр...
Expulsion of Adam from Paradise
Great Lent Begins Monday 022326**

Feb 22	Expulsion of Adam from Paradise CheeseFare Sunday
Feb 23	Monday Beginning of Great Lent
6:30 PM	<u>mon-tues-wed-thurs-</u> Great Canon of St. Andrew
6:30 PM	<u>fri – Akathist</u>
Feb 27	Fri – 6:30 PM Vespers Gr. Martyr Theodore
Feb 28	10 AM Service
Mar 1	Sunday of Orthodoxy Liturgy 930 AM
Apr 5	Sunday Palm Sunday . Liturgy 930 AM

PASCHA April 12, 2026

Fr John / 763 744 8601

Judas should not have betrayed his Lord; and the forgiveness he meets in Christ does not change this. The wrong is still a wrong, and it being forgiven does not mean it is accepted or acceptable, and more than it means it is dismissed as exonerated.

Nor is forgiveness to dismiss the pain that comes from wrongdoing. When the Mother of God forgave those who had killed her Son, the Creator of the universe, which she surely and wholly did, she did not, in this act, pretend that she no longer felt the grief occasioned by their act. Her forgiveness did not eradicate her tears.

Forgiveness, real forgiveness, is the liberation of the human heart. It is an act that we undertake in the face of wrong. To forgive is not to dismiss the flaws we behold in another; but it is to begin to see

them in light of the flaws and sin we see also in ourselves. Hatred of another's wrongs is harder to maintain when we are honest about our own; and condemnation is harder to justify, when we realise that we are ourselves in need of **mercy**. Can we withhold mercy to another, whose acts clearly demonstrates that he needs it, and then expect to receive it ourselves?

To forgive, my brothers and sisters, is to be honest: about ourselves, about each other, and above all about God and how He sees each one of us. It is therefore a commandment, not a suggestion: one cannot live in Truth without being truthful, and one cannot be honest and truthful before God without forgiving our neighbour — the neighbour who seeks our forgiveness, as well as the one who does not. The one who loves us in return, but also the one who hates us. We can do as Christ does, and as He commands; or we can walk away from Him altogether. There is no other path.

Today, therefore, let us each be honest Christians, and so start anew to taste the presence of real love by seeking each other's forgiveness, and granting it as our Lord commands. Amen!

(Bp Ireney)

† † †

Великий пост – время усиленной борьбы с грехом. Мы можем получить у Бога прощение наших согрешений, если и сами прощаем другим: *прощайте, и прощены будете* (Лк. 6: 37). Многим бывает трудно просить у других прощение. Гордость связывает язык. Церковь идет на помощь нам. Установлен день, когда мы искренне можем избавиться от накопившихся обид и неприязни. Надо заранее настроиться на это спасительное дело. В воскресный день за

Божественной литургией звучит Божественное предупреждение: *Если не будете прощать людям согрешения их, то и Отец ваш не простит вам согрешений ваших* (Мф. 6: 15). Каждый человек, зная за собой множество грехов, не может остаться спок ойным. Ему еще есть несколько часов подготовить себя, а вечером прийти в храм и после вечерни простить всех, кто с ним будет в храме, а также и тех, кого там не будет, если на них он имеет какую-нибудь обиду.

На исходе дня в прощенное воскресение человек испытывает особую радость, ибо по милости Божией сподобился быть прощенным теми, кого вольно или невольно обидел и огорчил. *Блажени миротворцы: яко тии сынове Божии нарекутся* (Мф. 5: 9).

The Great Lenten Canon of St Anrew of Crete

The Great Canon of St. Andrew of Crete is served twice during the year, both times during Great Lent. It is a very long Canon, so it is divided into four parts which are served Monday through Thursday during the first week of Lent, and on Thursday of the 5th week.

The Canon was written by St. Andrew, who was born in Damascus about 660. He embraced monastic life and went to Constantinople, where he was put in charge of a large orphanage. He was appointed bishop of Crete in 700. He wrote this masterpiece of poetry and spirituality toward the end of his life. It was only one of his many writings, and if studied, shows his familiarity with both the Old and New Testaments.

The Orthodox religion is one of hope. Even hymns that poetically allude to the crucifixion of Christ end with words of encouragement, as they speak of His Resurrection. This Canon tells it like it is. It is also unusual in that the first person “I” is used instead of “we”, which evokes a personal sense of repentance. Those who are familiar with the Bible will find this service a rich mind of spiritual treasures.

Here are some verses which show the penitential nature of this Canon: “How shall I begin to weep over the wretched deeds of my life? What beginning shall I make to this present lamentation?

But since You are compassionate, grant me the forgiveness of sins.”

“I have sinned more than all, I alone have sinned against You. But as God, have compassion on your creature, O Savior.”

“Arise, my soul, and review your deeds which have proceeded from your life. Scrutinize them closely and shed the rain of your tears, declaring openly to Christ your thoughts and deeds, that you may be justified.”



The Proof of Fasting St. John Chrosostom

Do you fast? Give me proof by your works.

If you see a poor man, take pity on him.

If you see a friend being honored, do not envy him.

Do not let only your mouth fast, but also the eyes and the ears and feet and the hands and all the members of our bodies.

Let the hands fast by being free of avarice.

Let the feet fast by ceasing to run after sin.

Let the eyes fast by disciplining them not to glare at what is sinful.

Let the ears fast by not listening to evil talk or gossip.

Let the mouth fast from foul words and unjust criticism.

For what is it if we abstain from birds and fishes, but bite and devour our brother?

When Thou, O God, shalt come to earth with glory, * and all things tremble, * and the river of fire floweth before the Judgement Seat * and the books are opened, and the hidden things made public, * then deliver me from the unquenchable fire * and deem me worthy to stand at Thy right hand, O most righteous Judge.

